REUSE INCENTIVE

WORKING GROUP MEETING #4

THURSDAY, APRIL 2, 2026

LICENSING AS INFRASTRUCTURE FOR OPEN SCIENCE

AGENDA

1. Welcome and Agenda Overview
2. Icebreaker: Member Intros
3. Recaps: Working Group Goals, Open Licensing with CC BY, and the Modular Paper Repo
4. Activity: Refining Our Guidance
5. Next Steps

ICEBREAKER: MEMBER INTROS

Breakout groups - pair up and share. When you come back, drop your answer in the chat!

- No ethical constraints, unlimited funding, all the time you need. What experiment do you run?

WORKING GROUP

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RECAP: WORKING GROUP GOALS

1. Surface points of friction around reuse and licensing of modular research

2. Explore how licensing serves as a technical and cultural enabler of reuse in modular research

3. **Produce a document with a framework and recommendations for modular science reuse (TODAY'S FOCUS)**

RECAP: OPEN LICENSING WITH CC BY

The only requirement for reuse is **Attribution (BY)**. Credit must be given to you, the creator.

Key Terms

Sharing: Publishing your work so that others can access, use, share, and/or build upon it.

Reuse: Accessing and using, sharing, and/or building upon someone else's work

License: A set of terms that specify how others can use, share, or build upon your work.

Attribution/Citation: Credit given to the original creator of a work when it is being reused.

RECAP: THE MODULAR PAPER REPO

Paper repo (PR) is made of a collection of objects, which is shareable as an object.

PR is made of claims/hypothesis headlines: containers of **panels of evidence (PE)**.

PE supports its claim with **text, figures, and tables,** as an embed or as its own PDF.

PE contains **panel dependencies (PD)**, with Code, Research Datasets, Design Files, or Lab Notes.

Researchers can then publish the entire paper repo as a **PDF Paper** (but not the dependencies, which can just be linked out).

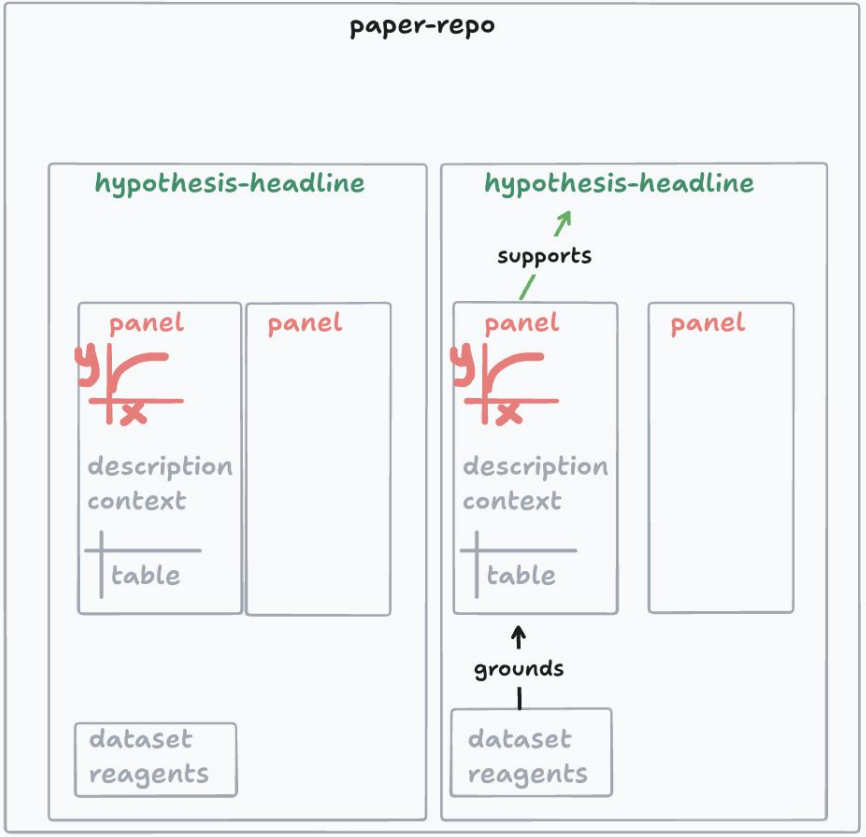

Figure by Matthew Akamatsu, 2025

ACTIVITY: OUR RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Ensure we know if and how we can reuse a component as a primary source, because we want to avoid not doing it or doing it wrong.

2. Ensure we know if and how we can license our components, and what proper licensing entails, because many are unaware what options exist or how to go about it.

3. Ensure we have a way to track attribution/credit received as an author, because otherwise authors have a hard time knowing how or where their work is being used.

4. Ensure we have a way to distinguish attributions/citations received for components vs. PEs (Panels of Evidence) vs PRs (Paper repositories), and for primary vs. secondary sources, because this can be useful for authors, especially when authorship happens across levels.

5. Ensure we have a way to easily know what a license is requiring and easily do it as we reuse a component, because licenses are easy to violate accidentally, and because respected attribution terms increase the likelihood of authors sharing their content for reuse.

6. Ensure we have a way to *track* if we did what the license required of us as reusers.

7. Ensure we have a way to show citations in context, because citation counts alone can be easily gamed, and because as research outputs become more modular the impact of a single citation will likely diminish.

8. Ensure we have access to a seamless formal research environment/ platform/ standard protocol for easily modular publishing of Paper Repos (PRs), Panels of Evidence (PEs), and components (writing, data, code, figures), with outputs interoperable across platforms, because this is what will make modular sharing practical at scale.

ACTIVITY: OUR RECOMMENDATIONS

Let's discuss together.

1. What is missing?

2. Which of these needs feels most urgent or familiar to you in your work, and why?

Recommendations and tactical details linked here:
https://docs.google.com/document/d/1ax0yJ2evWrAL3r9A7MsG5OCE3u-0ZssINgSw0K6DRG4/edit

NEXT STEPS

Final Meeting

- Th April 16 at 12pm ET

Join the Google Group

Takeaway Reading:

- eLife receives Wellcome boost to build open publishing ecosystem